

OREGON CITY COURIER

C. W. ROBEY, Editor and Business Manager

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THIRTY-FIVE YEARS AGO

Thirty-five years old. And we feel the gray hairs about our temples.

Next week we will celebrate, quietly, and without any display of our real bigness, the 35th birthday of the Oregon City Courier. We'll swell our chests in pride and count each year in our long history as a golden bead of success—a jewel in the age of progress, but we'll do it after the day's work is done and we are peacefully meditating the flight of time before the fireplace at home.

The Courier has been a factor in the journalism of Oregon and of Clackamas county. We feel grown up.

Yet, among us are men and women who knew us in our infancy. Men and women who knew us when we wore our first white dresses smeared over with the black ink of our first editorial.

Among these many people we have a multitude of friends. There are those who have never missed a copy of the Courier. We would like to hear from these people. Some of them have visited the office recently to tell us of the Courier's infancy—of the days which they know more about than we do—to tell us of the early editors and of their trials and tribulations.

To those of our readers who knew the Courier when it was young we address a respectful request for help. They can help us in our meditation by writing to us. Tell us what they know of the earlier days of the Courier; of the work it did and of the men who produced it. We reverence the past of the Courier, though our brief year in its management has not opened to us much of the history of its early days. Therefore, we must depend upon those of our readers who will be good enough, for old time's sake, to write to us upon our birthday.

Tell us what you can remember about the Courier's past lifetime, be it good or bad. We want to know on our birthday anniversary what kind of a life we have lived. Will those who know tell us these things by next Tuesday morning? Write a letter Sunday, mail it Monday and we will read it Tuesday.

A TALKATIVE COUNCIL

The Courier has said very little about the trivial quarrels, the personal feuds and the religious discourses, that have been hampering the work of the Oregon City council within the past year. We have kept above these cheap things simply because we have cherished a fervent hope that the councilmen would shortly get down to a business program and transact the work they were elected to undertake.

When the recall movement was at its height our sympathy was, in a large measure, upon both sides of the fence, because of the fact that the majority of the council members are not even attempting to do their duty by the city. And just as sure as shooting their's going to be a successful recall election in this man's town if this child's play in the council is not stopped. In the name of civic decency we'll shortly be forced to throw a few worthless councilmen out of their warm seats or force them to action at the end of a spar.

There is the most idle, useless lot of palaver east upon the smoky air of the council chamber that one can imagine. It is all talk and no work. There is no centralization of energy, no evident desire on the part of the honorable aldermen to do any constructive thing. True enough, many important matters are projected and find one or two ardent workers about the table, but the motif is lost in banter every time.

The council bids fair to debate for another year the question of acquiring the water board's property for a park site. The matter has been in debate at least a year. It also looks like Oregon City might expect a little street improvement work—when the pigs begin to fly.

The attention of the council has been called time and time again to

the filthy condition of the city streets. The council has talked and talked about the matter—but the talk has utterly failed to clean the streets. The Courier could not force itself to express surprise if an indignant public demanded recall measures. It would be only justice to the city and its people.

Main street is little better than an open sewer. Its surface is filthy. A muddy lane is in immensely more sanitary conditions than Main street. The council knows that. It knows that prevention is better than cure—but it makes no effort toward preventing an epidemic of disease that must come from these unclean conditions. There is a street committee in the council which approves a street cleaning budget every year. Yet the thing drops at that. The committee has made no effort to force the contractors to do the work they are paid to do. They talk about it but they don't do the work.

Meanwhile we soil our shoes, our clothes and our dispositions wading through the slime and dirt on Main street. Some day—perhaps about the time a regular city election or so comes into view—we can hope for definite action from the Oregon City council. Until then it seems probable that we will have to put up with whatever boon that magnanimous body of elected gentlemen sees fit to give us.

BUYING JUSTICE

With the commitment of Harry Thaw, slayer of Stanford White and plaything of American justice for a decade, to an asylum in Pennsylvania, those who have followed the dramatic career of the insane murderer may be pardoned their pause for reflection.

Many thinking people believe Thaw has been trifled with. The efforts of money, in whose name a million crimes have been committed, to secure justice for the man were the cause of his long incarceration and finally are the cause of his mental state. We were once fond of saying that justice was measured by the girth of one's purse. To a certain point that is still true.

Unfortunately, Harry Thaw's money was discovered by a public which demanded justice. It believed that Thaw's money was trying to prevent the measurement of justice in his case, with the result that the justice money tried to buy was denied the young criminal. He was not insane when he was committed to the asylum following his rash act in New York. But insanity was forced upon him.

Had Thaw been an obscure and penniless young rounder in place of a rich one, with a loving mother as treasurer, he would never have gone to the asylum. He would have paid for his crime in prison—if justice demanded that he pay the penalty. Many men have committed crimes of the same nature—and the unwritten law has been responsible for their freedom. But Thaw's money put him in the insane asylum where every mental environment was conducive of insanity. The result is that he has now been rightly declared mad.

Thaw committed a crime against justice and justice retaliated with a crime against Thaw. The crime of justice against Thaw was the greater of the two, if there is any distinction. Thaw killed a man less worthy of life than he was of the murderer's bullet. Mentally and morally the law killed Thaw by confining him as insane for so many years. And if there is any human way to judge between Thaw and White, the former was the better man, though that is saying little in his praise.

There is a moral in this case that could well be made a part of American justice. The tribunal that tries a man for his crimes against society should be honest. Money should not be recognized by the bench. Every man deserves to be tried upon the merits of his case—not upon the size of his purse. Boughten justice isn't justice at all.

COUNT ZEPPELIN

Upon the death of the famous German inventor, Count Zeppelin, the San Francisco Chronicle has the following to say:

Count Zeppelin well deserved the world-wide reputation he achieved as inventor of the first really successful type of dirigible airship. In a sense, he was a man of one idea, or rather one specific purpose, but the infinite variety of complications involved in the solution of his problem precluded the possibility of his being looked upon as a crank.

For a time he was so regarded, and, indeed, had he died ten or twelve years ago, at the age of, say, 69, instead of 79, he would have gone down in the history of aeronautics as one of the pioneers who failed.

It was not until nine years ago that he made the demonstration which set the seal of success upon a long lifetime of devotion to his specific purpose. Greater feats have been performed since by dirigibles constructed by the distinguished inventor, but it was the sailing in a straight course from point to point a distance of nearly nine hundred miles, which was covered in thirty-seven hours, by the 1908 Zeppelin which set the laurel wreath of fame upon the brow of the illustrious German aristocrat.

In these days of warfare, when many things capable of being used in the service of mankind are diverted to purposes of destruction, there is apt to be less of the all-around international tribute to the genius who has just passed away. The use to which Zeppelins have been put does not appeal to the people of those countries against which the airships have been directed, but it should be remembered that the advent of peace will make it possible to experiment with dirigibles as common commercial carriers.

Even as the submarine seemed to be only an instrument of destruction until the Deutschland arrived with a large cargo and suggested new possibilities for commercially constructed divers, so may the Zeppelins, which have shown such accuracy in direction over long distances and at exceptionally high safety altitudes, do much as rapid carriers in times of peace.

In any case, the name of Zeppelin will be entered upon the scroll of fame, and if his type of craft be subsequently developed into one of international use, its recent military exploits will be forgotten, and its inventor honored in all the lands.

A SOURCE OF PROSPERITY

It is a fact that western Oregon cannot afford to overlook that every state that has gone into dairying on an extensive scale has experienced a great increase in prosperity. Wisconsin, perhaps the leading dairy state of the Union, is noted for the prosperous condition of its people—particularly its rural population. Minnesota's industrial development has grown by leaps and bounds since dairying was taken up on a large scale. Missouri has reached new levels of comfort and plenty by paying close attention to the dairy cow and even Iowa's splendid combination of corn and hogs was incomplete until the dairy industry was added. Many other eastern and middle western states have had the same experience.

Yet western Oregon possesses advantages that are possessed by none of these states that have won success by the aid of the dairy cow. It has a mild and pleasant climate in which green feed can be produced throughout a large part of the year and which makes possible production of butter and cheese of the highest possible quality. It is near the seaboard and in normal times has access to ships that will deliver its products cheaply, by way of the canal, in all the great markets of the world. The corn crop and the silo, added to these other resources, have opened up great new possibilities to the Oregon dairymen.

The step that must first be taken is to secure good stock, and this cannot be done in a day. Good dairy stock is scarce and hard to find, but diligence and determination will overcome greater problems than this. If the people of Oregon make up their minds that the dairy industry means greater prosperity for them and set out to build up dairy herds now, a way will be found to get the stock. —Eugene Register.

PHYSICAL TRAINING

It is significant of the marked change in public opinion that the superintendency division of the National Educational association, which held its annual convention at Kansas City, went on record for compulsory physical training for school pupils, with universal military service (training) throughout the nation for men 20 to 21 years old.

A stand of that nature would have been impossible two years ago, and if it had been taken by a body of educators would have aroused a whirlwind of protest.

The plan now recommended by these educators is basically sound. Military training, as such, should be kept out of the schools, but physical training, for girls as well as the boys, should begin in the grades and be carried up through high school and college.

With this physical training should go thorough medical and dental inspection of our boys and girls, with systematic reports and counsel to parents, and in all cases where the parents are financially unable to give the needed correcting treatment, it should be provided by the school district, says the Spokesman Review.

This great and wealthy nation could not spend a portion of its wealth in a better or nobler undertaking than that of starting the rising generation in life with an endowment of health and physical vigor. Systematic physical instruction, and systematic remedying of physical defects uncovered in such training, would save countless millions from death or suffering and set the nation on a high plane of physical and intellectual vigor.

KEEP THE BROOD SOW

Again Portland livestock markets

are sounding warning to the hog raisers of the northwest to keep their brood sows. Several loads were on the Portland market last week. The present industry, which was built up through much effort on the part of the breeders, stock yard and packing companies of the northwest, is being threatened with disaster. It will not be long before many of these same men who are sending their sows to market will be trying to buy, seeing the grave mistake they are making. And when this will be done prices for brood sows will go soaring and will be hard to obtain at any price. This condition applies not alone to the northwest but to the entire United States—and especially in Oregon. Usually it is the low prices that force the marketing of these sows, but this time it is the extreme high prices prevailing. Hog raisers think they are taking advantage of the high prices by shipping every head of swine they possess, but as has been said before, they will soon awaken. The high prices farmers are obtaining for their stock are all right as far as they go, but the fact remains that if the movement of brood sows to market continues, there will be nothing left to again rebuild the industry.

THE GREAT AMERICAN DESERT

When the Utah prohibition law becomes effective one can go from ocean to ocean, 3,500 miles, without seeing a saloon. Starting from Wilmington, N. C., the traveler on this boozeless highway could traverse North Carolina, South Carolina, Georgia, Alabama, Mississippi, Arkansas, Oklahoma, Kansas, Colorado, Utah, Idaho and Oregon.—American Issue.

A SONG OF ROADS

Miss Anderson Sings Parody on Dixie to Live Wires and Grangers

Miss Lillian Anderson, daughter of County Judge H. S. Anderson, paraphrased a parody on Dixie Land, the famous southern melody, and sang it delightfully at the meeting of the Live Wires at Harding grange at Logan on Tuesday evening. Employing her own words in many of the lines, Miss Anderson sang "Look at Home!"

"We wish we lived in a land of good roads; Small teams then could pull their big loads, Look at home! Look at home! Look at home! Oregon! Our Oregon is a land of mudholes, Swimming lanes with teams of tadpoles; Look at home! Look at home! Look at home! Oregon!"

Chorus— "Don't we hope to die in Oregon? O say? O say? For Oregon let's take our stand, To live and work for Oregon. At home! At home! At home west in Oregon!"

"In Oregon that we were born in, Land of mud we now are stuck in, Look at home! Look at home! Look at home, Oregon! In ruts and cuts and splash and spatter Make us sad and a little sadder. Look at home! Look at home! Look at home, Oregon!"

"Now don't we want to end this sorrow? Why not build good roads tomorrow? Look at home! Look at home! Look at home! Oregon! In Oregon we're bound to travel. Look at home! Look at home! Look at home, Oregon!"

POSITIVE PROOF

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BONDS OPPOSED

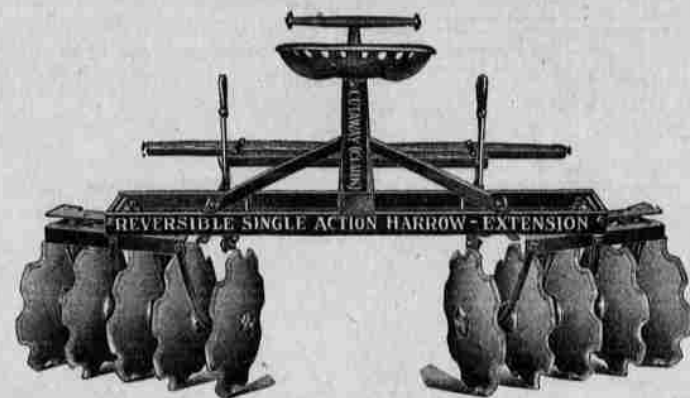
Maple Lane Grange Says Attempt Will be to Favor Millionaires

Maple Lane grange, in session on Saturday, passed the following resolutions strongly condemning the proposed \$6,000,000 road bond issue:

Whereas, The legislature of Oregon, which has just adjourned, passed a bill proposing to bond the state for the sum of \$6,000,000, with which to build scenic highways with the provision that said bill be referred to the people at a special election to be held the 4th of June, 1917, and

Whereas, We believe that the said bonding bill is only the first issue of a series to involve the further issuance of some \$40,000,000 more, and

Whereas, an effort is being made through our new highway commission to place our road problem and money in the hands of a few millionaires, therefore be it Resolved, That we, the members of Maple Lane grange, P. of H., No. 236, in regular session assembled on the 10th of March, 1917, are most emphatically opposed to the issuance of the said \$6,000,000 bonds, and that each and every one will do all possible to defeat this measure at the said election, and be it further Resolved, That a copy of these



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resolutions be sent to our local papers and the Oregon Grange Bulletin.

ANNA G. LEWIS, Secretary.

FARMERS

Sing a song of farmers, Up at early morn, With four-and-twenty chores to do Before the breakfast horn. When the breakfast's over, There's little to be done, Except to plow the fodder, And let the harrows run, And mow the sheep and prune the beets And curdy up the swine, And shear the hens and dig the hay And shoe the gentle kine, And saw the wheat and rake the rye, And wash and dress the land, And things like that which city folks Can never understand.—Life.

"A Good Old-Fashioned Physic"

Foley Cathartic Tablets, a wholesome physic, thoroughly cleanse the bowels, sweeten the stomach, tone up the liver. For indigestion, biliousness, bad breath, bloating, gas or constipation, no remedy is more highly recommended. Wm. O. E. Bielke, Hancock, Mich., writes: "I have given Foley Cathartic Tablets a thorough trial and I can honestly recommend them as a mild but sure laxative. They work without griping." Give stout persons a free, light feeling. —Jones Drug Co.

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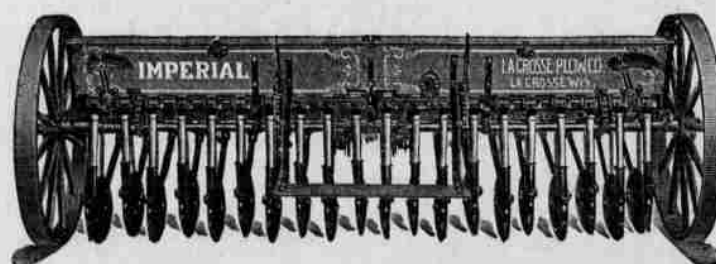
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